Gianna Brachetti-Truskawa

Search Experience Product Manager

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PROFILE

Product manager and organic growth leader with 17+ years in international search, now working where search, AI, and security overlap. Published multi-level AI crawler governance with the IAB. Sees teams like an octopus: multiple independent, intelligent minds that align and grow as one organism. Cross-functional leadership across engineering, product, and marketing in 30+ language markets.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager, Search & CMS – DeepL SE

2022 - Present Cologne

- Lead a cross-functional team of 7 (engineers, QA, product designer, content strategist) and manage freelancers, owning organic user growth and **search experience** strategy for a high-growth enterprise SaaS product (B2C and B2B) across 30+ language markets. Grew organic traffic by 200% within the first year.
- Own the **search experience for anonymous web users** - discovery, content surfacing, and conversion flows across 30+ language markets. Initially also served as product manager for **Linguee, DeepL's linguistic search engine**.
- Own content pipeline for landing pages, comparison pages, funnel pages, and conversion pages. Established cross-functional SEO alignment across the entire company, bringing together engineering, product, and marketing to resolve structural growth blockers.
- Work as product manager with a dedicated engineering team, shipping technical SEO improvements and platform changes. Own and prioritise the tech SEO backlog. Practise agile, test-driven, and spec-driven development.
- Build and maintain measurement and attribution dashboards (SQL, Metabase) to track organic impact on engagement and conversion. Reframed organic growth metrics from traffic share to engagement and conversion.
- Built an internal tool to create synthetic prompts and track LLM visibility, citations, and competitive intelligence across multiple models (hackathon, early 2024) - before commercial tools offered this capability.
- Built a semi-automated **prompt engineering framework** that let marketing colleagues fill in a short form and receive optimised prompts and results after multiple LLM iterations - removing the need for manual prompt crafting.
- Introduced frontend e2e testing at the company, including specific SEO QA automation with SpeedCurve, Audisto, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, and Playwright for continuous quality monitoring.

VP of SEO – KaFe Rocks Ltd (acquired by Gaming Innovation Group)

2019 - 2022 Malta / Remote

- C-level SEO leadership for an international iGaming affiliate managing **70+ domains** in a **YMYL niche** where advertising restrictions meant 99% of traffic and revenue depended on organic search. Highly volatile rankings and aggressive competitor tactics made this one of the most demanding SEO environments to operate in.
- Grew and stabilised the portfolio and launched a new domain with a community-driven content model.
- Built and mentored the SEO and QA teams from scratch, establishing the technical excellence, domain management practices, and bot detection capabilities that made sustained growth possible. Introduced frontend end-to-end testing for SEO quality assurance.
- Built systems and honeypots to detect and defend against fraudulent DMCA notices, content scraping, and copying - protecting the company's organic assets in a market where competitors actively attack each other's rankings.
- Drove **programmatic SEO** strategy for scaled content generation across multiple regulated markets.

International Senior SEO Manager – bold ventures GmbH

2018 - 2019 Cologne

- Technical and international SEO strategy for a software house, working exclusively with large enterprise clients in B2B eSignature technology and **biopharmaceutical equipment manufacturing**.
- Optimised for multi-platform discovery including Spotify. Presented on multi-platform and micro search systems optimisation at conferences.

International Senior SEO / Audience Manager – Aufeminin Group

2017 Cologne / Paris

- Staff role reporting directly to the Managing Directors (Stabsstelle der GF). Led team of international SEO managers across the group's European properties, including user-generated content platforms (gofeminin.de, sofeminine.co.uk and locale variants) and editorially produced **medical content (Onmeda.de** and international equivalents).
- Educated and guided large editorial teams on SEO best practices for both the UGC and medical content properties, driving content quality and search performance without formal line authority.
- Designed and implemented server log monitoring and analysis process for crawl behaviour insights at scale.
- Managed programmatic SEO for scaled content across multiple European markets.

Senior SEO Manager – Chefkoch GmbH

2015 - 2017 Bonn

- Managed SEO and **search experience** for **Chefkoch.de, Germany's largest recipe search engine** with a 65 million URL estate.
- Fine-tuned and tested the on-site search experience, using search result data and user behaviour signals to improve relevance and discovery.
- Used search result features to promote internal links, feeding search behaviour data back into SEO-driven content decisions.
- Early adopter of **structured data** (Schema.org/JSON-LD) from its first days, spearheading implementation across Bertelsmann companies. Collaborated directly with a **Google technical team** as the first company in Germany to test new markup formats. Achieved over 100% visibility gain through Rich Results and AMP.
- Designed and built a context-sensitive affiliate product placement feature that programmatically adapted to the user's search query and the recipe they were viewing, creating a new revenue stream for the company.
- Drove programmatic SEO for scaled recipe and category page generation.
- Built automated JIRA-based content optimisation workflow, reducing manual coordination overhead across editorial and development teams.

Head of SEO – netspirits GmbH & Co. KG

2014 - 2015 Cologne

- Built new SEO expert team from scratch. Developed content marketing strategies for clients across eCommerce, NGOs, and web hosting.

Team Lead SEO – arvato Bertelsmann

2012 - 2014 Cologne

- Led team of four SEO specialists managing large international e-commerce projects for Microsoft, ASUS, Toshiba, and **major online pharmacies in a regulated healthcare market**.
- Technical consulting for CMS migrations across Magento, Hybris, and Demandware platforms.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

SEARCH & DISCOVERY	AI & SECURITY	PRODUCT & LEADERSHIP
Strategic International SEO, Technical SEO, On-page SEO, Keyword research, Query fan-out analysis, Core Web Vitals, Log file analysis, Schema / JSON-LD, Content architecture, Crawl infrastructure, Localisation, Multi-language content	AI crawler governance, GEO (Generative Engine Optimisation), Prompt engineering, Meta-prompting, LLM behaviour analysis, Crawl security, Adversarial content analysis	Cross-functional programme leadership, Framework design, Stakeholder communication, Executive presentation, Systems thinking, Team building, coaching & mentoring, Freelancer management
TOOLS & DATA	**HUMAN LANGUAGES**	**MACHINE LANGUAGES**
Google Search Console, Bing Webmaster Tools, Naver Search Advisor, Yandex Webmaster, GA4, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, Semrush, Audisto, Botify, Metabase, Claude CLI, Gemini CLI	German (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Italian (intermediate), Turkish (intermediate), Spanish & Portuguese (written understanding), Dutch (beginner), Norwegian (beginner)	SQL (basics), Python (basics)

PUBLICATIONS

Multi-Level Approach to Managing AI Crawler Behaviour and Content Protection (IAB, 2024)

Qualification Characteristics of Swearwords and Their Significance in Translation (Bachelor thesis, 2012)

MEMBERSHIPS

WiCyS - Women in Cybersecurity (since 2025)

Women4Cyber Foundation (since 2025)

EDUCATION

BA Multilingual Communication (grade 1.3) 2012

TH Koeln - Cologne University of Applied Sciences

Commercial Agent in Dialogue Marketing (Apprenticeship) 2008

IHK

ELSEWHERE

Building an MCP server for Audisto to integrate crawl data into AI-assisted workflows. Personal connection to **healthcare**: half my family works in the sector. I have proofread and corrected **medical research papers**, helped write SOPs for hospitals, and run smaller security tests in my free time. Volunteer in geriatric psychiatry (2004-2005). Faculty board member, TH Koeln (2011-2012). Former freelance translator (DE/EN/FR/IT).